MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | DevOps and Platform Engineering
marta.kowalbrandt@example.com | +48 555 303 303 | gitlab.com/mkb-example

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including a recent focus on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams and has built Helm-based ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster. Personal experience includes a k3s homelab with GitOps, monitoring and Terraform-provisioned VPS infrastructure. Seeking to move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, pipeline optimization, artifact publishing
Containers and orchestration: Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access and test-environment deployments), k3s
Infrastructure as Code and GitOps: Terraform (personal VPS project), Argo CD, Ansible (basic)
Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki; test metrics dashboards
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)
Languages and data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems: Linux, Git

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health Software | 2023–2024

- Built a GitLab CI workflow that deploys a short-lived application and PostgreSQL environment with seeded data to the shared Kubernetes cluster using Helm.
- Configured automatic environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; QA and product teams use the environments for feature review and e2e testing.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health Software | 2022

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelized test jobs, added dependency caching and separated e2e tests into their own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health Software | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Helped teams identify and address frequent offenders; the flaky test rate fell from 7% to below 1%.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024–2025

- Set up a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Added Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering builds, unit, integration and e2e test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Built ephemeral test environments for merge requests using Docker Compose and later Helm charts on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright e2e suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, now used in team onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications through manual and automated testing for client projects.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027 (not yet certified)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)